

Assignment 1: Write a Bio

It's the first introduction to who you are, what you do, and what you're interested in—whether a blurb on a social media platform, a personal website, or company team page...It's an opportunity for you to—in a few lines—showcase your work, competence, and areas of expertise. In short, it's the first look at your personality.

Honeysett, A. (2018). *A Template to Write Your Own Professional Bio*. Themuse.com.
Retrieved 23 January 2018, from <https://www.themuse.com/advice/the-professional-bio-template-that-makes-everyone-sound-accomplished>

Example

Promoting positive community and economic growth in our neighborhood.



Phil Gutowski moved to East Boston from St. Thomas, USVI. He studied engineering and business at the New York Maritime College and proceeded to work in a fast, upscale environment, assuring client delight on luxury super yachts. Passionate about the water, the move to Eastie was a natural fit. With encouragement from friends and neighbors, Phil started the East Boston Real Estate Company in 2011. In his free time, Phil loves to go sailing with his girlfriend Ali. He also runs a local **musicians studio**, and loves promoting live music events. Grateful for an amazing group of neighborhood

friends, Phil makes sure that new residents are welcomed in a way that has become customary in East Boston.

Example

JAMIE MAY, M.A.

Our Social Media Manager

Jamie received her master's in English with a concentration in professional writing from Southeastern Louisiana University. She has taught in the program since 2007 and was promoted to senior instructor in 2012. She manages the PTW Facebook and Twitter accounts as well as the English Department's social media networks.



Her Research Interests:

- ⇒ Pop culture and pedagogy
- ⇒ Document design
- ⇒ Typography
- ⇒ Teaching English and technical communication
- ⇒ Secondary language arts instruction

FUN FACT:

Jamie spent her undergraduate years singing in a cover band around Louisiana and Mississippi!

Courses She Teaches:

- ⇒ English 2080: Business Writing
- ⇒ English 2090: Technical Writing
- ⇒ English 3080: Advanced Professional and Technical Writing
- ⇒ English 3130: Document Design
- ⇒ English 3140: Managing Writing Projects
- ⇒ English 3750: Grant Writing

More Examples



Mark Gallion
@m_gallion

Can read a spray chart and a balance sheet. 1 part Executive, 1 part entrepreneur, 2 parts geek and 3 parts baseball coach. Too many parts?

<https://blog.hubspot.com/marketing/professional-bio-examples>



ABOUT ANN

This is Ann Handley's website, and this is a bit of copy about her. She is best-selling *author*, social media and content marketing *keynote speaker*, the Chief Content Officer of MarketingProfs, and a monthly columnist for Entrepreneur magazine. That's not giving you a lot of detail, is it? So read more *here*.

<https://blog.hubspot.com/marketing/professional-bio-examples>

Why are they so different?

Why not just use the examples as templates?

Assignment Information

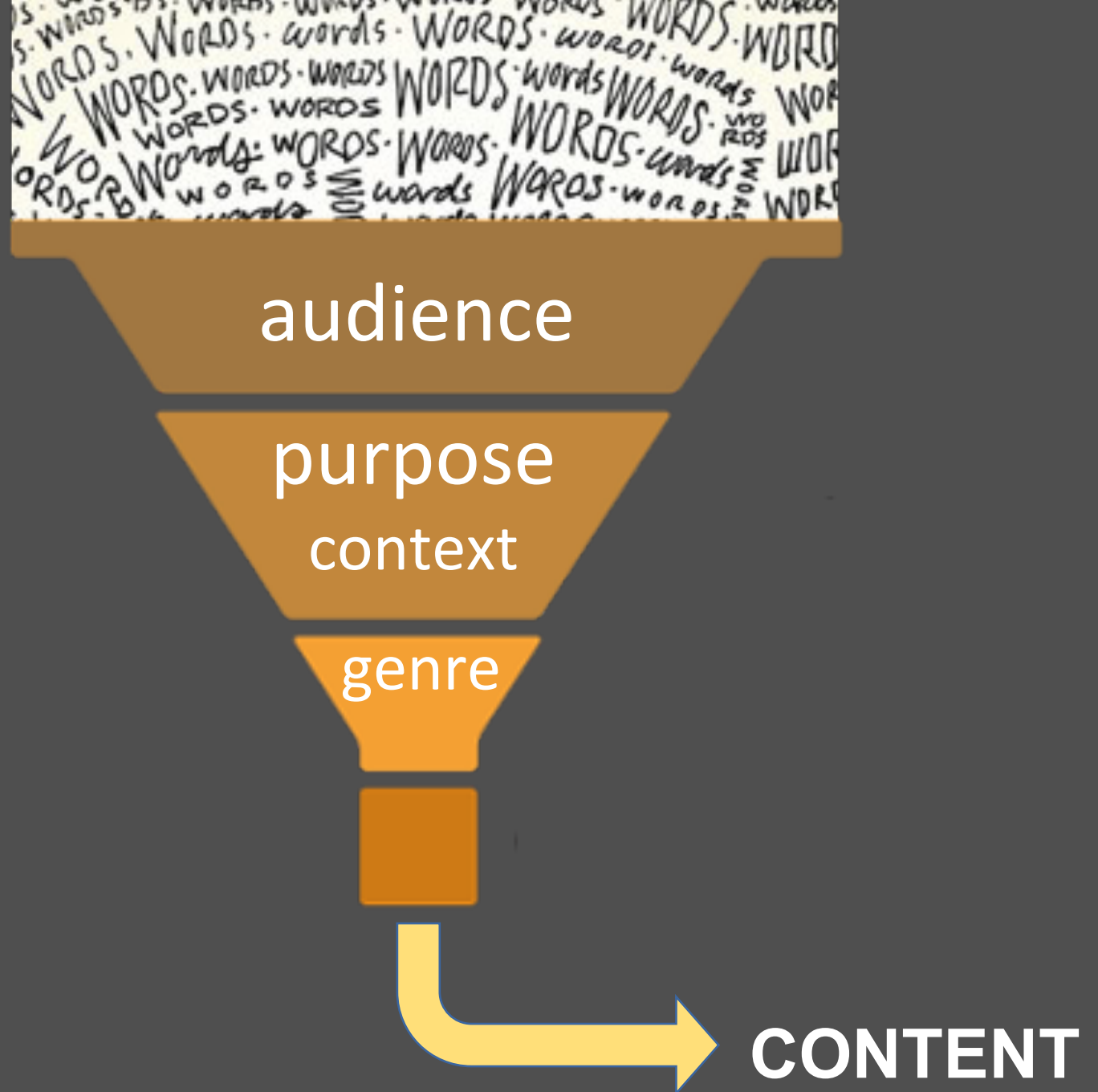
Genre: professional bio

Audience: classmates

Audience purpose: select preferred team members
for collaborative projects

The Writing Process

- Identify your audience and their needs
- Articulate your purpose
- Understand context and genre



Show vs Tell

- When you “tell” your audience facts, you making a claim.
- Without concrete evidence, details, facts, stories, or other supporting information, your claim is not supported.
- In other words, “telling” is general; “showing” is specific.
- Support your claims with concrete, specific details that “show” your audience that your claim has validity.

Example

Cheryl Birkelo, M.A.

Senior Instructor, Professional and Technical Writing Program (12 years)

Department of English, University of Colorado Colorado Springs

After earning her M.A. in English at South Dakota State University (2000), Cheryl relocated to Colorado and worked as a technical writer for Sturman Industries, and then at a small marketing firm before returning to teaching at the Air Force Academy USAFA and UCCS. In the early 1990s, she worked for South Dakota State Wildlife Fisheries and taught at the secondary and collegiate levels. Over the past 35 years, she has employed her writing, editing, and organizational/administrative skills for a wide variety of projects including user guides, training and laboratory manuals, marketing materials, website content, academic journals and educational curricula. Cheryl guides students to improve their writing in practical, real-world ways that focus on purpose, audience, design, and editing.

For the past eight years, Cheryl lives most of the year in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia with her husband, Carl. His work with ACDIVOCA (<http://www.acdivoca.org/projects/feed-enhancement-for-ethiopian-development-ii-feed-ii/>) focuses on sustainable agriculture to support small farmers throughout Ethiopia. Cheryl and Carl have been married for over 40 years. She has two adult children, and enjoys gardening, crocheting, and doing volunteer work along with her husband in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia. Their project has two more years of funding by the USDA. Then, they will return to the USA and a new life adventure.

Communication Is a Process



<http://www.bizuit.com/portals/0/Procesos.png>

- Articulate your **purpose** (goals)
- Identify your **audience**, their purpose, and their information needs
- Organize and **develop content** using an appropriate style
- **Design content** so audience can easily find information or perform their tasks
- Evaluate and **improve** your communication